

The AI is above par. Enemies are smart and know exactly where to throw grenades and how long to hold them before they throw them at you. They will perform different tactics to try and nab you and each encounter is different from the next in some way.

SOFII uses a modified version of the *Quake III* engine with a GHOUL system (body specific damage and gore modifier), which makes the character detail quite awesome, if you have the hardware for it. The environments looked wonderfully detailed and textured. While a majority of the levels feel like you are in a giant warehouse, there is plenty of eye candy in the forest levels where

the trees add a new level of detail to the tactical aspect of this game.



INFILTRATION: *The multiplayer options should keep you engaged for quite a while*

The random mission generator is not spectacular, though it can create an endless series of single player fun. There are various game styles: Multiplayer, Infiltration, Capture the Flag, Deathmatch, and Team Deathmatch. From a multiplayer point of view, this game is a winner. Given the number of features this game offers and its numerous gameplay modes, it's a good value-for-money buy.

Genre: First Person Shooter

Developer: Raven Software

Distributor: Milestone Interactive

Phone: 022-8381614

Web site: www.activision.com

Price: Rs 999

Rating: ★★☆☆☆

SPIDER-MAN: THE MOVIE

Spider on your PC

Fresh from the release of *Spider-Man: The Movie*, comes an action adventure game of the same name. The game has been released on all gaming platforms simultaneously by Activision, including the PC, which plays just like the console version.

The storyline is identical to the movie, with a series of excellent full motion CG videos that carry the plot forward. The game drops you right into a tutorial after Peter Parker has discovered his abilities. In the training level, you learn that Spidey can crawl on any surface, catapult across the skyline, and zip across a room with his web. The story starts out with Spider-Man being framed by an imposter and your goal is to clear your name, whilst fighting off

the bad guys and the cops who think you are the bad guy. Your skills will be put to the test across eight locations, spanning 30 levels and you will find yourself slinging from the rooftops trying to rescue hostages in a building that has been taken over by pink blobs.

The fighting system is one of the coolest parts of the game. You can shoot a ball of web at someone, cover yourself with an exploding web dome, or even use your web to pull bad guys towards you for some nice hand-to-hand combat. Being able to unlock new combos and web-slinging over New York remain one of the most thrilling parts of the game.

The game plays similar to a *DOOM* style objective system. While playing indoors, you unlock doors, travel back, grab a fuse from thugs to unlock more doors, go forward. Outdoors, you fly past convincingly rendered skyscrapers that really do seem like they are scraping the sky. Unfortunately, the controls are so maddeningly difficult that it sucks the joy right out of an amazingly colourful and well-textured game. The camera system is not

responsive enough to player movement, and often distracts during crawling and fighting sequences on the ground. Unless you have a gamepad with two-directional buttons, trying to fly Spider-Man around the screen, shoot webs, and control the camera at the same time is an impossible task.

The graphics are fantastic, with hardware T&L (Transform and Lighting) support, smoke, lens flares, and fog effects. The character models, like Venom and Carnage, look really cool. In addition to smoothly animated characters and moves, the explosions and fire effects are also quite effective, lending a real sense of comic-book action. But the eye candy comes at the steep price of a 32 MB 3D accelerator card.

The techno soundtrack and voice acting enhance the whole experience. Notably, the game incorporates voices by the actors involved with the movie including Willem Dafoe and Toby Maguire. *Spider-Man: The Movie* has no multiplayer component, but the power ups and web-slinging fun will ensure plenty of re-playability.

Genre: Third Person Action Adventure

Developer: Treyarch Invention

Distributor: Milestone Interactive

Phone: 022-8381614

Web site: www.activision.com

Price: Rs 999

Rating: ★★☆☆☆



MORAL OF THE STORY: *With a great graphics card comes great looking visuals*